

## 5. GRAB GIFT-GIVING SUPPLIES FOR LESS

Those sales I mentioned above are not just for decor items; they're for gift-giving too. Stock back up on bows, wrapping paper, and Christmas cards for just pennies, and you'll always replenish your stash by spending hardly a thing. But if you wait too long and miss out on the deep discounts, dollar stores are the best place for tissue paper and bags.

When it comes to gifting presents, it's good to keep various sizes of cardboard and packaging boxes on hand whenever you can find them. Gift bags are fine for big and bulky items, but I always prefer wrapping in a box when I can. I actually have a box of boxes in my closet specifically for this purpose!

Also, if I'm not able to stock up on cards and gift tags after the holidays, I'll comb through my craft supplies to make my own. Simple cardstock, stickers, and creative punches are all you need to create a gorgeous handmade card in minutes.

## 6. CELEBRATE ON A DIFFERENT DAY (OR WEEK)

Christmas Day is special, not because of the day we celebrate it on, but because of who we celebrate it with. If you live out of town, consider having Christmas as an immediate family, but celebrate it on a different day with extended loved ones. It's less stressful, not to mention much cheaper!

For instance, the year we moved to Florida, we also had a wedding to attend back in NY. That meant we were running low on funds for Christmas plane tickets. Which if you're not used to traveling around the holidays, airplane tickets and fees that time of year can cost a pretty penny.

We decided it would be better, and cheaper, to fly up in early January and celebrate Christmas with my family a week later. No, it wasn't exactly on